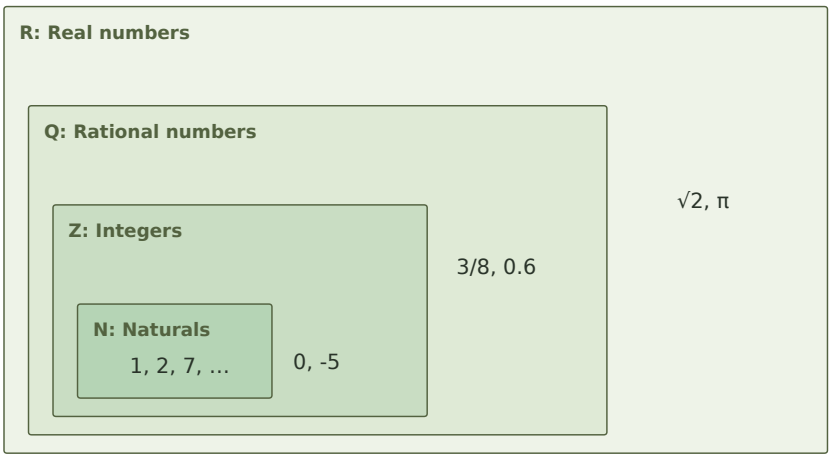
WEEK 1 / NUMBER SYSTEMS

Counting, movement, scaling, and repeated change

Connect arithmetic to quantities, positions, fractions, and rules that act one step at a time.



Every inner box is included in every box around it.

Each smaller system is included in the systems around it. A number can have several correct descriptions.

Start with what the number means

Seven can count books, identify a bus route, mark a temperature, or describe a change. The setting tells us which calculations make sense and what their answers mean.

Try the short checks before reading the explanations in the solutions. The practice sets retain all 28 original exercise and review groups. A brief complex-number preview extends the picture; the classification exercises use N, Z, Q, and R. The situations and forecasts are hypothetical.

Online reading · Explorer · Laboratory

1.1 Start with what the number describes

The same number can do different jobs. Seven can count books, name a bus route, mark a temperature, or describe a change in a game score. Before calculating, ask what the number means and which units go with it.

A number is more useful with a question attached

"12" could mean 12 minutes, 12 dollars, or the label on a storage bin. Adding two waiting times can make sense. Adding the labels on two bins does not tell us how much they contain.

This week connects several ways of thinking about numbers: counting, locating, sharing, scaling, and repeating a rule. Each view helps us decide which calculation answers the question.

Pause and try 1

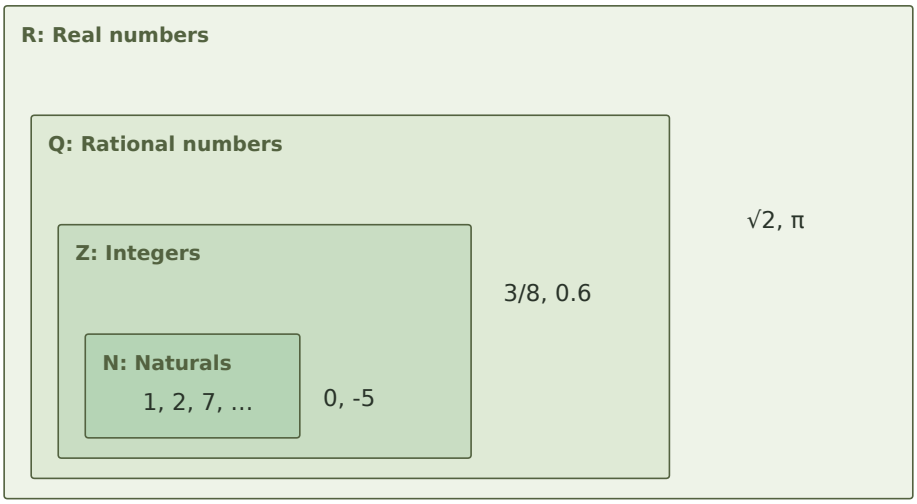
Does "Bus 8" mean that the bus contains eight people? What extra information would a count of eight passengers give you?

1.2 The number systems fit inside one another

A *set* is a collection. The familiar number systems are sets of numbers. We use different names because different situations require different kinds of values.

System	Meaning	Examples
Natural numbers, $\mathbb{N}$	Positive counting numbers	1, 2, 3, ...
Integers, $\mathbb{Z}$	Whole numbers, zero, and their negatives	..., −2, −1, 0, 1, 2, ...
Rational numbers, $\mathbb{Q}$	Ratios of integers with a nonzero denominator	3/8, −5/2, 0.6, 7/1
Real numbers, $\mathbb{R}$	All positions on the number line, rational or irrational	$\sqrt{2}$, π, and all the numbers above

Here the natural numbers start at 1. The term *whole numbers* usually means 0, 1, 2, ... The classification tasks use the four listed systems, so zero's smallest listed system is the integers.



Every inner box is included in every box around it.

Being in a smaller box also puts a number in every box around it. These are inclusions, not four unrelated categories.

$$\mathbb{N} \subset \mathbb{Z} \subset \mathbb{Q} \subset \mathbb{R}.$$

The symbol $\subset$ means "is contained in." Every integer is rational because it can be written over 1: $-5 = -5/1$. Every rational number is real. The reverse statements need not hold: $3/8$ is rational but not an integer.

When a task asks for the *smallest* listed system, it asks for the most specific description. A fraction may simplify first: $8/4 = 2$, whose smallest listed system is natural. "Real but irrational" describes a real number outside the rational-number box; the symbol $\mathbb{R}$ itself includes rational numbers too.

Pause and try 2

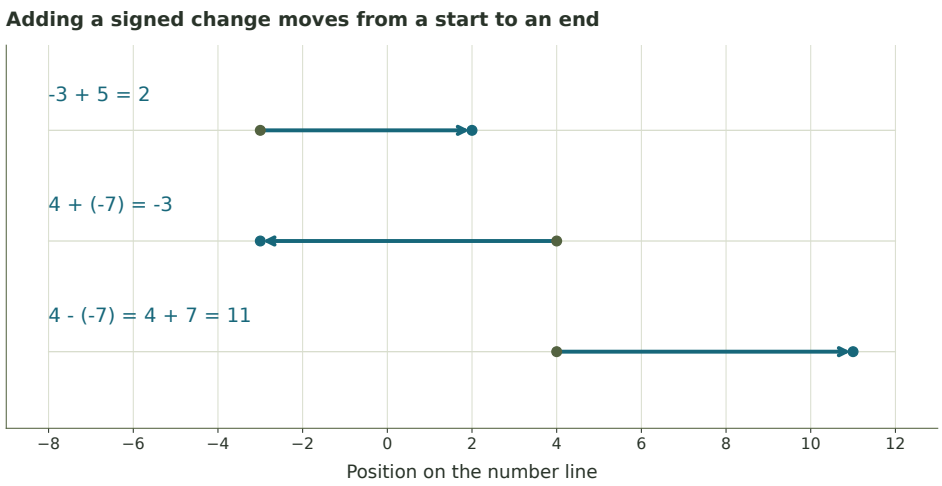
Classify -6, 0.25, and $10/2$ by their smallest listed systems.

1.3 Addition describes a signed change

A number line gives zero a location and fixes which direction is positive. On a horizontal line, right is positive and left is negative. A signed change tells us how far to move and which way.

Start, then make the change

For $-3 + 5$, start at -3 and move 5 units right. The end position is 2. For $4 + (-7)$, start at 4 and move 7 units left. The end position is -3.



A positive starting position does not force a positive result. Keep the start and the signed change separate.

Subtracting a number means adding its opposite. Therefore $4 - (-7) = 4 + 7 = 11$. The minus sign in "-7" is part of the number being subtracted; taking its opposite gives $+7$.

Fractions can describe steps too: $1/3 + 1/2$ means moving a half-unit right from one third. We will use a common unit to calculate that sum below.

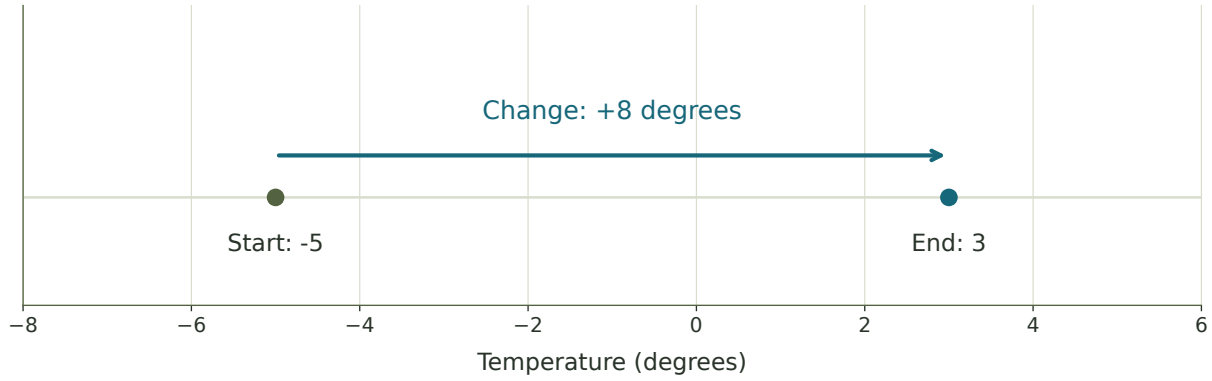
Pause and try 3

A submarine is at -45 meters relative to the surface and rises 18 meters. Where does it end?

1.4 A position and a change are different

If a temperature rises from -5 to 3 degrees, the final temperature is 3 degrees. The change is $+8$ degrees. Answering "3" and answering "$+8$" describe different things.

A position and a change answer different questions



End position = start position + signed change. To recover the change, subtract the start from the end.

Follow several changes in order

A hiker starts at −20 feet relative to sea level, climbs 35 feet, then descends 8 feet. The positions are −20, 15, and 7 feet. The final position is 7 feet; the net change from the start is +27 feet.

Choose units and a reference point before using negative values. A negative elevation can mean below sea level. A negative bank balance can mean an amount owed. A negative count of books on a shelf would usually signal that the chosen model no longer fits the situation.

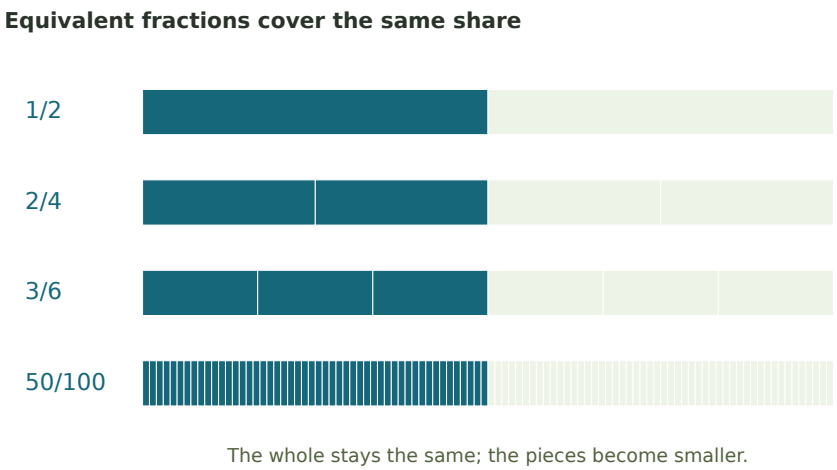
Pause and try 4

A game score changes from 14 to 9. What is the change, and how would you write the update?

1.5 Fractions name shares and locations

In 3/4, the denominator 4 says that one whole is divided into four equal parts. The numerator 3 says to take three of those parts. For a length, 3/4 also marks a position between 0 and 1.

Different fractions can name the same share. Multiply the numerator and denominator by the same nonzero number to keep the value unchanged: $1/2 = 2/4 = 3/6 = 50/100$.



The whole has the same size in every row. More pieces does not necessarily mean a larger amount.

Two ways to check equivalence

3/4 and 9/12 are equal because both numerator and denominator were multiplied by 3. You can also cross-multiply: $3 \times 12 = 36$ and $4 \times 9 = 36$.
For 2/5 and 7/15, the cross-products are $2 \times 15 = 30$ and $5 \times 7 = 35$. They are different values.

In symbols, a/b = c/d exactly when ad = bc, provided b and d are nonzero. Division by zero is undefined. To simplify 18/24, divide both parts by their greatest common factor, 6: the result is 3/4.

A decimal is another way to write a share. 0.6 means six tenths, so $0.6 = 6/10 = 3/5$. A percentage uses hundredths: $0.6 = 60/100 = 60\%$.

Pause and try 5

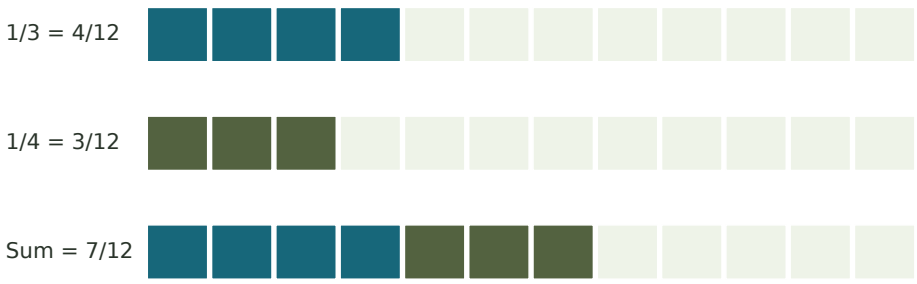
Are 6/10 and 9/15 equivalent? Show one check.

1.6 Use the right operation with fractions

To add fractions, first express them in the same-sized pieces. One third and one fourth are different units; twelfths let us count both together.

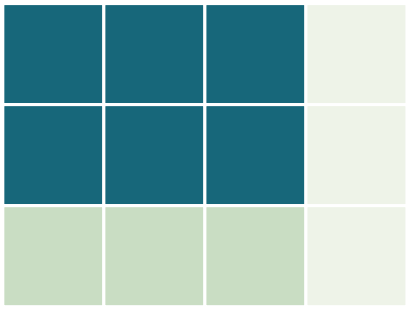
$$\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{4} = \frac{4}{12} + \frac{3}{12} = \frac{7}{12}.$$

Use the same-sized pieces before adding fractions



Add the numbers of matching pieces. Adding denominators would change the unit instead of combining the amounts.

Multiplication asks a different question. Taking two thirds of a recipe that uses three quarters of a cup means multiplying the two fractions.



Original amount: 3/4 = 9/12 cup

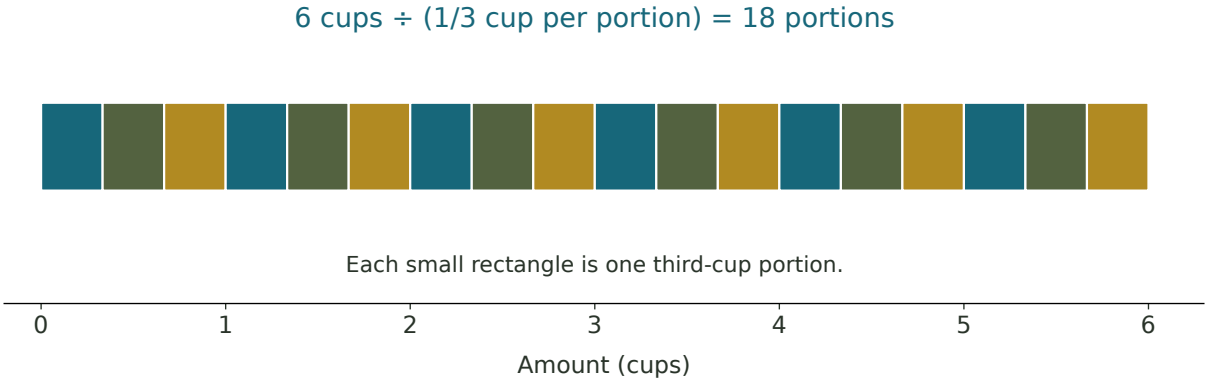
Take 2 of its 3 rows:

(2/3) × (3/4) = 6/12 = 1/2 cup

The full 4-by-3 rectangle represents one cup.

Multiply numerators and denominators: $(2/3)(3/4) = 6/12 = 1/2$.

Division can count portions. If each portion is 1/3 cup, how many fit into 6 cups? There are three thirds in each cup, giving 18 portions.



$6 \div (1/3) = 6 \times 3 = 18$. Dividing by a small positive fraction can produce a larger number.

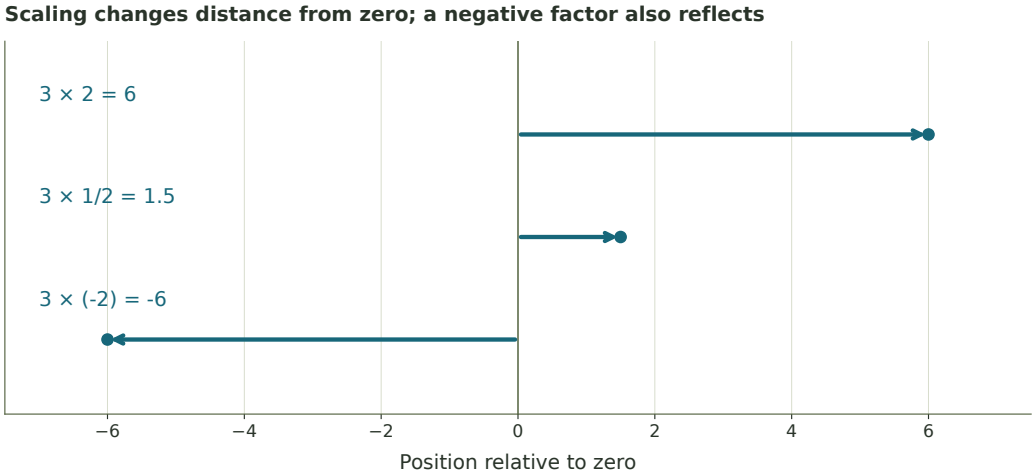
In general, dividing by a nonzero number is multiplying by its reciprocal. The reciprocal of $2/3$ is $3/2$ because their product is 1. For example, $(5/6) \div (1/3) = (5/6) \times 3 = 5/2$.

Pause and try 6

Find $1/2 + 1/4$ and $(1/2) \times (1/4)$. Why are the results different?

1.7 Multiplication describes a scale factor

A factor tells us how a value is scaled. Multiplying a positive amount by 2 doubles it. Multiplying by $1/2$ halves it. Multiplication is therefore not always an increase.



For a nonzero value, a factor's absolute size changes distance from zero. A negative factor also changes the side of zero.

For a positive amount, a factor greater than 1 makes it larger; a factor between 0 and 1 makes it smaller; 1 leaves it unchanged; 0 gives zero. A negative factor reflects across zero while scaling the distance.

Two negative signs as two reversals

Multiplying by -1 reflects a point across zero. Applying that reflection twice returns to the original side, so $(-1)(-1) = 1$. In $(-2)(-5) = 10$, the negative value is scaled by 5 and reflected again.

Be careful with words like "larger." Multiplying -4 by 2 gives -8, which is farther from zero but less than -4 on the number line. The simple greater-than-1 growth rule for amounts assumes the starting amount is positive.

Pause and try 7

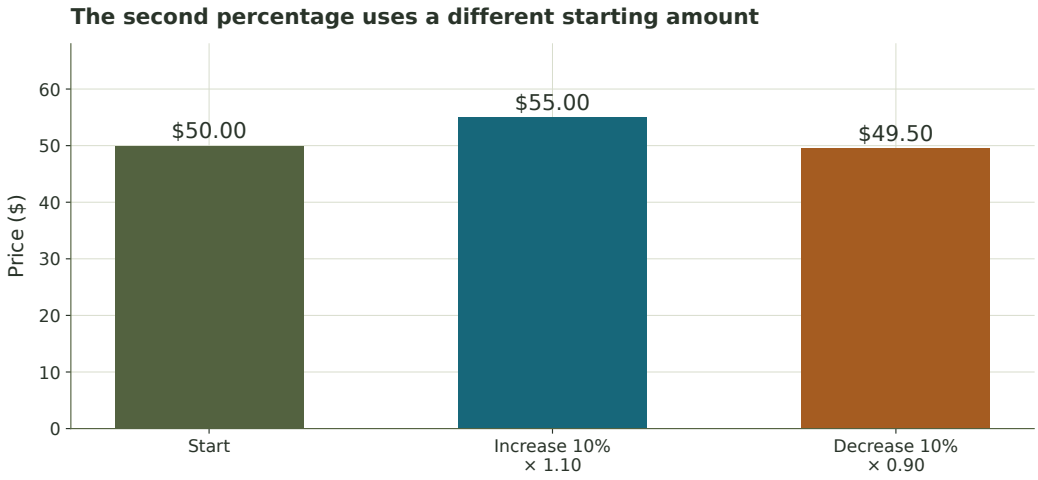
Without calculating exact results, compare $9 \times (1/3)$ and $9 \div (1/3)$ with 9.

1.8 A percentage change becomes a multiplier

Percent means "per hundred." A 10% increase keeps the original 100% and adds another 10%, giving $110\% = 1.10$ times the old amount. A 10% decrease keeps 90%, so its factor is 0.90.

$$\text{increase factor} = 1 + \frac{p}{100}, \qquad \text{decrease factor} = 1 - \frac{p}{100}.$$

Here p is the percentage number: use $p = 10$ for 10%. For 6% growth, the factor is 1.06; it is not 6 and not 0.06.



The second percentage applies to 55 dollars, so the two changes do not cancel.

Adding a fixed amount and applying a fixed percentage can agree for one step and then differ. Starting at 100, adding 20 gives 120, 140, 160. Growing by 20% gives 120, 144, 172.80, because each new 20% is taken from the current amount.

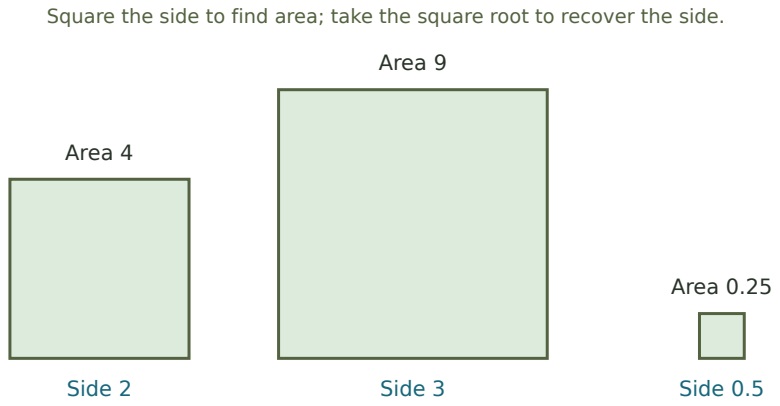
Pause and try 8

A quantity of 80 increases by 25%. What factor applies, and what is the new quantity?

1.9 Powers, square roots, and the order of operations

A power records repeated multiplication. The expression 3^2 means 3×3, while 3^3 means $3 \times 3 \times 3$. The small raised number is an *exponent*. It counts how many copies of the base are multiplied.

The square-root sign asks for the nonnegative number whose square gives the number inside. Thus $\sqrt{9} = 3$, $\sqrt{0} = 0$, and $\sqrt{1/4} = 1/2$.



A square root can be a fraction. The square-root sign does not automatically indicate an irrational number.

Keep the sign and the grouping visible

$(-4)^2 = (-4)(-4) = 16$, and $\sqrt{16} = 4$. Both 4 and -4 solve $x^2 = 16$, but the symbol $\sqrt{16}$ names only the nonnegative choice.
Compute $2 + 3 \times 4$ by multiplying first: $2 + 12 = 14$. With parentheses, $(2 + 3) \times 4 = 5 \times 4 = 20$.

Work inside grouping symbols first, then evaluate powers and roots, then multiplication and division from left to right, then addition and subtraction from left to right. A fraction bar also groups its numerator and denominator.

The distributive property says a(b + c) = ab + ac. If a movie club charges 12 dollars plus 4 dollars per visit, the cost for n visits is 12 + 4n. Three people each making n visits pay 3(12 + 4n) = 36 + 12n dollars in all.

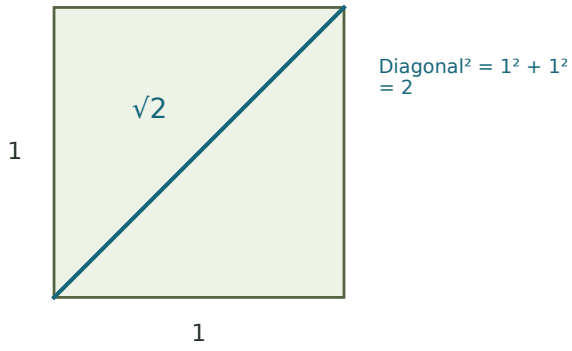
Pause and try 9

Evaluate $3(2 + 5)$ and $3 \times 2 + 3 \times 5$. Then find $\sqrt{(-3)^2}$.

1.10 An exact number and a decimal approximation differ

A rational number can be written as a ratio of integers. Its decimal ends or eventually repeats a block: $3/4 = 0.75$, while $1/3 = 0.333\ldots$ with the 3 repeating forever.

An *irrational* number is real but cannot be written as a ratio of integers. Its decimal never ends and never settles into a repeating block. $\sqrt{2}$ and π are examples.



√2 ≈ 1.41421, but the finite decimal is only an approximation.

The diagonal has an exact length even though no finite decimal writes that length exactly.

For a nonnegative integer, its square root is rational exactly when the integer is a perfect square, such as 0, 1, 4, 9, or 16. The qualification "integer" matters: $\sqrt{1/4}$ is rational too.

A calculator display is an approximation

$\sqrt{2} \approx 1.41421$. The sign $\approx$ means "approximately equal." The finite decimal 1.41421 is rational; it is not exactly $\sqrt{2}$. A number's exact definition tells us its type, not just the digits a calculator displays.

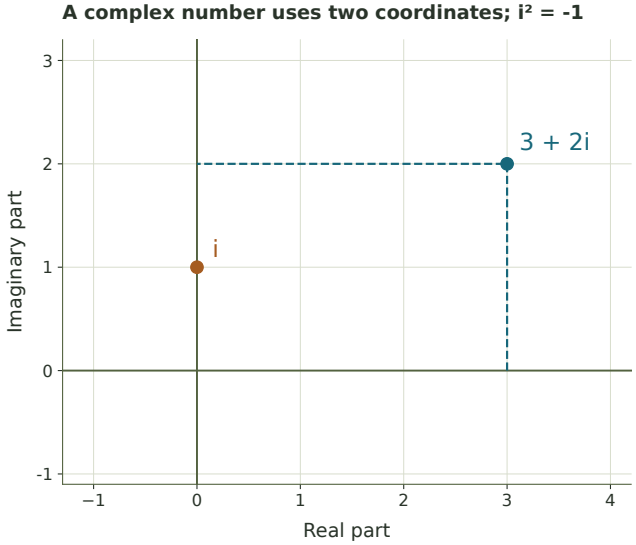
Pause and try 10

Are $\sqrt{25}$ and $\sqrt{6}$ rational or irrational? Is the finite decimal 2.44949 irrational?

1.11 A glimpse beyond the real number line

No real number squares to -1: the square of a real number is never negative. The *complex numbers* extend the real numbers by introducing i, with $i^2 = -1$.

A number such as 3 + 2i has two parts. We can draw it at the point (3,2): three units along the real direction and two along the imaginary direction. "Imaginary" is the standard name for this direction; it is part of a precise number system.



Real numbers lie on the horizontal axis. Complex numbers allow points elsewhere in the plane.

This extends the tower to $\mathbb{R} \subset \mathbb{C}$, where $\mathbb{C}$ denotes the complex numbers. The classification tasks in this week's assignments use the four real-number systems introduced above.

Pause and try 11

What are the real and imaginary parts of $5 - 2i$?

1.12 Recursion: use the current value to find the next

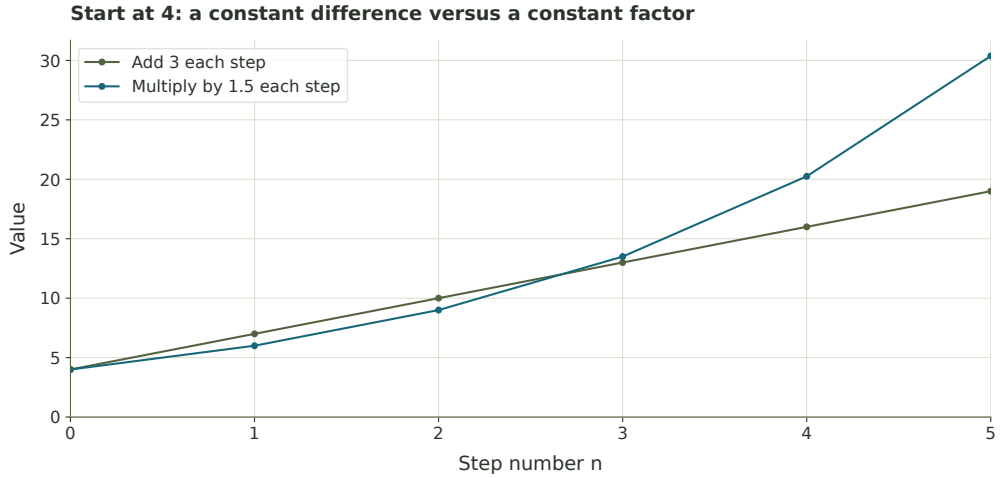
A *sequence* is an ordered list. A *recursive rule* tells us how to make a new term from an earlier one. We need both a starting value and an update rule.

Read the notation as an instruction

Let $a_0 = 4$ and $a_{n+1} = a_n + 3$. The small numbers are step labels. a_0 means the starting value, a_1 the value after one update, and a_2 the value after two updates. The expression n + 1 means the next step after n.
The rule says: take the current value and add 3. Starting from 4 gives 4, 7, 10, 13, 16, 19.

Step n	Add 3 each step	Multiply by 1.5 each step
0	4	4
1	7	6
2	10	9
3	13	13.5
4	16	20.25
5	19	30.375

In the second column, the difference between consecutive values stays at 3. In the third, the ratio stays at 1.5. Both start at step 0, before any updates have happened.



The horizontal axis counts updates. It does not represent the value of the sequence.

A *direct formula* can jump to a particular step. With start a_0 and fixed addition d, $a_n = a_0 + nd$. With start b_0 and fixed factor r, $b_n = b_0 r^n$. The exponent n counts the multiplications; the subscript n labels the term.

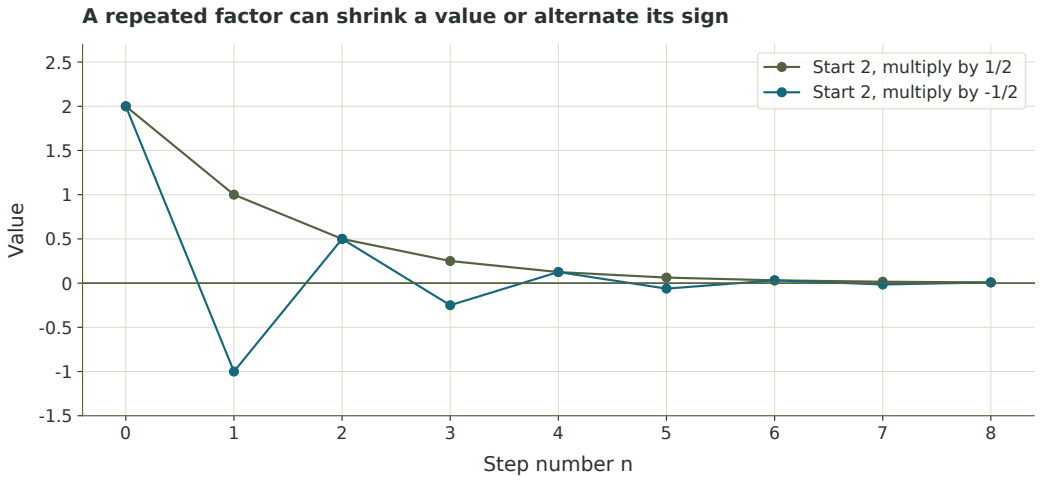
For the examples above, $a_5 = 4 + 5(3) = 19$ and $b_5 = 4(1.5)^5 = 30.375$. A table, a recursive rule, and a direct formula describe the same sequence in different ways.

Pause and try 12

Start at 9 and subtract 2 at each update. List the start and four updates. What is the step-4 value?

1.13 Check what a repeated rule can reasonably describe

A fixed multiplier does not always mean growth. Multiplying a positive value by 1/2 repeatedly makes it smaller. Multiplying by $-1/2$ also alternates its sign.



The starting value and the factor both matter. A factor below 1 does not have the behavior of positive percentage growth.

With a positive start and a constant factor greater than 1, repeated multiplication eventually exceeds a fixed positive addition, if the rules continue indefinitely. That is a mathematical statement about those rules. A real population may run out of space or resources long before an indefinite forecast makes sense.

A useful model has a setting

If a car's model value drops by 1,500 dollars every year, the arithmetic can eventually become negative. That is a reason to reconsider the model, not a prediction that the owner must pay someone to take the car.

The explorer compares repeated rules on shared axes. The growth application uses two household forecasts. The discussion asks what a repeated change could mean in your own experience.

Next week uses fractions as shares of observations and as probabilities. Later feedback models use the current state to help determine the next state. The starting point is the same habit: say what a number means, show the update, and check the result in context.

Pause and try 13

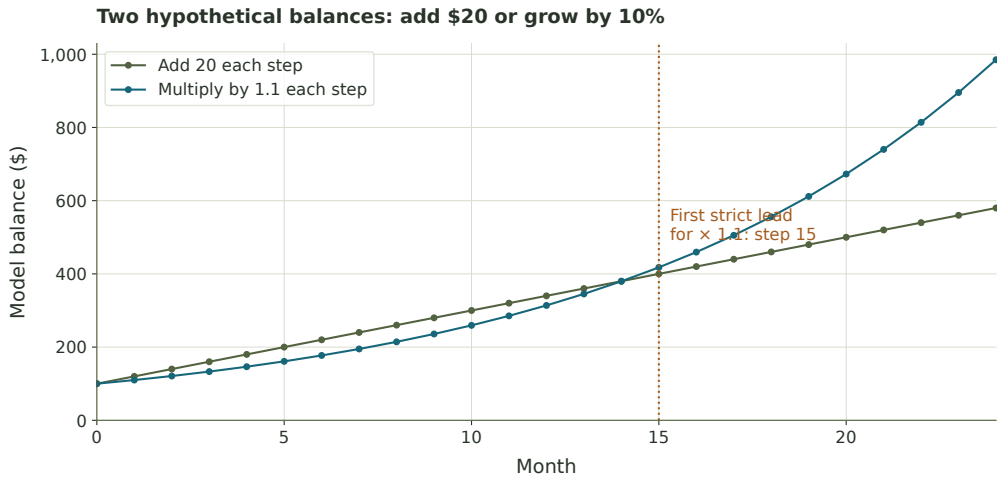
A model starts with 6 liters and subtracts 2 liters each day. What happens after day 3? Can the physical amount follow that rule forever?

More worked examples

Two hypothetical balances

Start both models at 100 dollars. A adds 20 dollars each month. B multiplies by 1.10, representing 10% growth per month. Keep exact values while updating and round only the displayed amounts.

Month	A: add 20 dollars	B: multiply by 1.10
0	100.00	100.00
1	120.00	110.00
2	140.00	121.00
3	160.00	133.10
4	180.00	146.41
5	200.00	161.05



Both rules use a positive start. The factor 1.10 exceeds 1, so the repeated multiplication eventually leads if the rules continue.

At month 12, A is 340.00 dollars and B is 313.84 dollars, so A still leads. At month 14, A is 380.00 and B is about 379.75. B first leads at month 15: 417.72 dollars versus A's 400.00. By month 48, the model values are 1,060.00 and 9,701.72 dollars. These are consequences of the stated update rules, not guarantees about actual accounts.

Why the diagonal is not a fraction

The unit-square diagonal has squared length $1^2 + 1^2 = 2$, so its exact length is $\sqrt{2}$. Here is a short argument that it cannot be a ratio of integers.

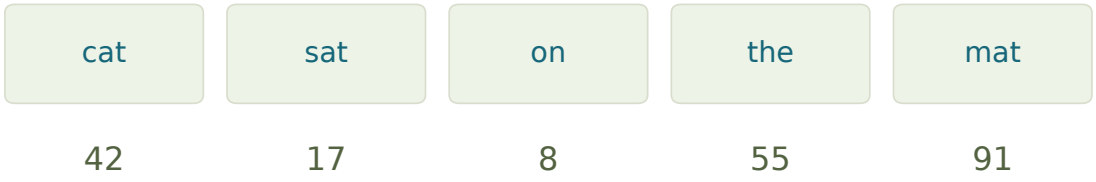
Suppose $\sqrt{2} = p/q$ in lowest terms, with positive integers p and q. Squaring gives $p^2 = 2q^2$. Thus p^2 is even, which forces p to be even: an odd number has an odd square. Write $p = 2k$.

Substitution gives $4k^2 = 2q^2$, so $q^2 = 2k^2$. Then q is even too. Both p and q would share the factor 2, contradicting the assumption that the fraction was in lowest terms. This contradiction rules out a rational representation.

Numbers that label text

A token ID identifies a piece of text in a vocabulary. Its size does not measure meaning or dictate sentence order. In one invented vocabulary, the phrase “cat sat on the mat” has IDs $42, 17, 8, 55, 91$.

Text order chooses the order of the IDs.



42, 17, 8, 55, 91 — an ordered list of labels, not amounts.

The text gives the order of the labels. Rearranging the labels changes the text.

If a prompt contains 4 tokens and one token is appended per step, its length is $L_n = 4 + n$. The length follows an additive rule. Which token is chosen is a different question, developed through probability in Week 2.

Activities and further reading

Use the explorer to compare sequences and fraction locations. The growth application compares household forecasts; the text-and-numbers application distinguishes labels from quantities. The discussion asks you to interpret a repeated change of your own.

OpenStax reviews real numbers and square roots. Hugging Face describes tokenizers and token IDs.

Practice A: Number systems

Use the smallest of N, Z, Q, and R. Here N starts at 1, and the R answer means a real number that is irrational.

A1. Classify (a) 12, (b) -5, (c) $3/8$, (d) $\sqrt{5}$, (e) 0, and (f) $6/3$.

A2. Decide whether each statement is true or false and justify it in one sentence: (a) Every integer is rational. (b) Every rational number is an integer. (c) The repeating decimal $0.333\ldots = 1/3$ is rational. (d) Some real numbers are not rational.

A3. Write 0.75 as a simplified fraction and identify its smallest listed number system. Explain why $\sqrt{3}$ is not a ratio of integers.

Practice B: Addition and signed changes

B1. Compute (a) $-8+5$, (b) $-2+(-6)$, (c) $7-(-4)$, (d) $0+(-9)$, (e) $1/4+1/4$, and (f) $2/3+1/6$.

B2. A hiker starts at trail position -6, moves 10 units forward, then 14 backward. Write both changes as additions, give the position after each move, and mark all three positions on a number line.

B3. An account starts at -230 dollars, receives a 500-dollar deposit, then a 185-dollar withdrawal. Write the signed additions and find the final balance.

Practice C: Multiplication and scaling

C1. Compute (a) $(-3)7$, (b) $(-4)(-5)$, (c) $8(1/4)$, (d) $10 \div (1/5)$, (e) $(2/3)(3/4)$, and (f) $(5/6) \div (1/3)$.

C2. Explain in one sentence why $(-1)(-1) = 1$ using reversal across zero.

C3. Without first finding exact results, compare each with the positive starting value 7 and explain why: (a) $7(3/2)$, (b) $7(1/2)$, (c) $7 \div (1/2)$, (d) $7 \div 3$.

Practice D: Rational equivalence

D1. Test each pair for equivalence, showing cross-products: (a) 4/6 and 6/9, (b) 5/8 and 15/25, (c) 7/11 and 21/33, (d) 3/7 and 9/20.

D2. Simplify (a) 12/16, (b) 15/35, (c) 24/36, (d) 100/250.

D3. Simplify $0.6 = 6/10$, then use cross-products to verify the equivalence.

D4. Explain in one sentence why $\sqrt{4}$ is rational while $\sqrt{2}$ is not.

Practice E: Operations and roots

E1. Compute (a) $9 + (-14)$, (b) $-6 - (-10)$, (c) $8(3/4)$, (d) $9 \div (1/3)$, (e) 7^2, and (f) $\sqrt{144}$.

E2. Identify each as rational or irrational: (a) $\sqrt{16}$, (b) $\sqrt{7}$, (c) $\sqrt{100}$, (d) $\sqrt{50}$.

E3. A student claims $\sqrt{36}\sqrt{4} = \sqrt{36 \cdot 4}$. Check both sides, then compare $\sqrt{9}\sqrt{9}$ with $\sqrt{9 \cdot 9}$.

Practice F: Recursion

Include the starting value when listing the first six terms. Label the start as step 0.

F1. List the first six terms and identify the rule type: (a) start 5, add 4; (b) start 1, multiply by 3; (c) start 100, add -10; (d) start 2, multiply by 1/2.

F2. A bacterial population starts at 500 and doubles every hour. Write the recursion, make a table for hours 0 through 5, and give a direct formula for hour n.

F3. A car starts at 18,000 dollars and loses 1,500 dollars of model value each year. Give the first six terms. When does the model reach zero?

F4. Two models start at 1,000. A adds 200 per year; B grows 15% per year. Without calculating beyond year 5, predict which will be larger in year 20. Explain your reasoning in two sentences, assuming both rules continue.

Chapter 1 Review

R1. Classify by the smallest listed system: (a) $8/4$, (b) -17, (c) $\sqrt{11}$, (d) $-6/2$.

R2. A diver starts at the surface, descends 15 meters, rises 8 meters, then descends 5 meters. Write each move as a signed addition and give the final position relative to the surface.

R3. Are $8/14$ and $12/21$ equivalent? Simplify both and check the cross-products.

R4. A recipe uses $3/4$ cup of flour. How much is needed for $2/3$ of the recipe? Show the multiplication.

R5. An insect colony starts at 80 and triples every two weeks. Give the model values at weeks 0, 2, 4, 6, and 8. Write a formula using n for the number of two-week updates, and identify the rule type.

R6. A sequence is $5, 5.5, 6, 6.5, 7, \ldots$. Identify its type, give the term at step n with the start at $n = 0$, and find the step-20 value.

R7. Compute $\sqrt{64} + 3^2 - ((-4) \cdot 2)$, showing the order of operations.

R8. The diagonal of a unit square has length $\sqrt{2}$. Explain in two sentences why this is a real but irrational number.

Solutions and reasoning

Short check 1. The route number is a label. A passenger count is a quantity. The same numeral can play either role, and the context tells us which.

Short check 2. -6 is an integer. $0.25 = 1/4$ is rational but not an integer. $10/2 = 5$ is natural. All three are also real.

Short check 3. $-45 + 18 = -27$ meters. The submarine is still 27 meters below the surface.

Short check 4. The change is $9 - 14 = -5$. Write $14 + (-5) = 9$.

Short check 5. Both simplify to $3/5$. Their cross-products also agree: $6 \times 15 = 90$ and $10 \times 9 = 90$.

Short check 6. The sum is $2/4 + 1/4 = 3/4$. The product is $1/8$: one half of one fourth. Combining two amounts and taking a fraction of an amount are different operations.

Short check 7. Multiplying by $1/3$ gives less than 9. Dividing by $1/3$ is multiplying by 3, giving more than 9.

Short check 8. The factor is 1.25. The new quantity is $80 \times 1.25 = 100$. The increase itself is 20.

Short check 9. Both distributive expressions give 21. The squared quantity is $(-3)^2 = 9$, so its nonnegative square root is 3.

Short check 10. $\sqrt{25} = 5$ is rational. $\sqrt{6}$ is irrational because 6 is a nonnegative integer that is not a perfect square. The finite decimal 2.44949 is rational, even if it is being used to approximate $\sqrt{6}$.

Short check 11. The real part is 5 and the imaginary part is -2. Its point is $(5,-2)$.

Short check 12. The list is 9, 7, 5, 3, 1. The step-4 value is 1. Including the starting value gives five listed terms, not four.

Short check 13. The model values at days 0 through 3 are 6, 4, 2, and 0 liters. Continuing the arithmetic would give negative amounts. An actual stored amount cannot keep following that rule after the supply is exhausted.

Practice A: Number systems

A1. (a) N. (b) Z. (c) Q. (d) R, real but irrational. (e) Z under the four listed choices. (f) $6/3 = 2$, so N. Every one is also real; the task asks for the smallest listed system.

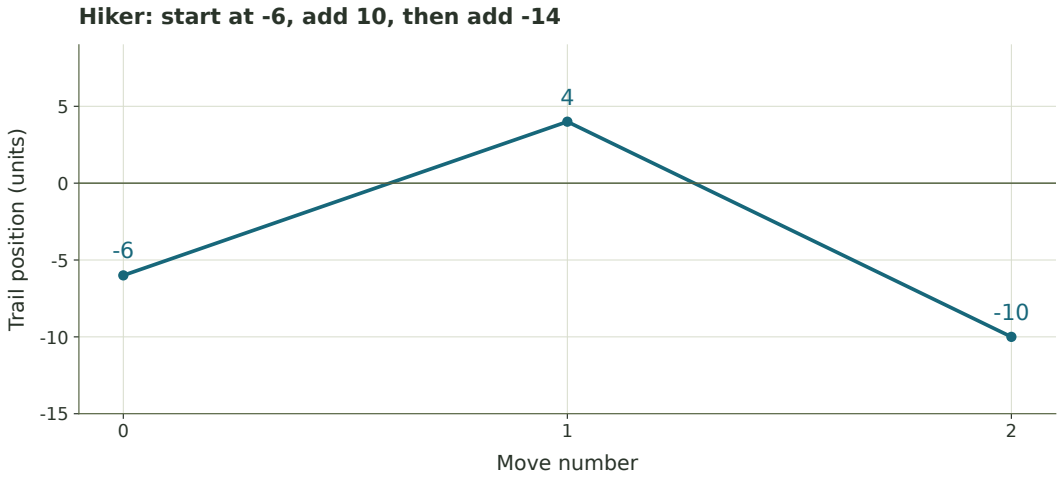
A2. (a) True: any integer k equals $k/1$. (b) False: $1/2$ is rational but not an integer. (c) True: $1/3$ is a ratio of integers. (d) True: $\sqrt{2}$ is one example.

A3. $0.75 = 75/100 = 3/4$, so its smallest listed system is Q. The square root of a nonnegative integer that is not a perfect square is irrational; 3 is such an integer, so $\sqrt{3}$ is not a ratio of integers.

Practice B: Signed changes

B1. (a) -3. (b) -8. (c) 11. (d) -9. (e) $1/2$. (f) $2/3 + 1/6 = 4/6 + 1/6 = 5/6$.

B2. The signed updates are $-6 + 10 = 4$, followed by $4 + (-14) = -10$. On a number line, mark -6, 4, and -10, with the first move right and the second left.



The graph records position after each move. The three marked values are the locations to place on a number line.

B3. $-230 + 500 + (-185) = 270 - 185 = 85$. The final balance is 85 dollars. The deposit is positive and the withdrawal is negative.

Practice C: Scaling

C1. (a) -21. (b) 20. (c) 2. (d) $10(5) = 50$. (e) $6/12 = 1/2$. (f) $(5/6)(3) = 15/6 = 5/2$.

C2. Multiplication by -1 reverses direction across zero, so doing it twice returns to the original positive unit.

C3. (a) Greater: the factor $3/2$ exceeds 1. (b) Less: the factor $1/2$ lies between 0 and 1. (c) Greater: division by $1/2$ multiplies by 2. (d) Less: division by 3 multiplies by $1/3$. These comparisons use a positive starting value.

Practice D: Equivalence

D1. (a) Equivalent: $4(9) = 6(6) = 36$. (b) Different: $5(25) = 125$ and $8(15) = 120$. (c) Equivalent: $7(33) = 11(21) = 231$. (d) Different: $3(20) = 60$ and $7(9) = 63$.

D2. (a) $3/4$ after dividing by 4. (b) $3/7$ after dividing by 5. (c) $2/3$ after dividing by 12. (d) $2/5$ after dividing by 50.

D3. $6/10 = 3/5$ after dividing numerator and denominator by 2. The cross-products agree: $6(5) = 10(3) = 30$.

D4. $\sqrt{4} = 2 = 2/1$ is rational, whereas $\sqrt{2}$ cannot be written as a ratio of integers, as the lowest-terms argument in the worked examples shows.

Practice E: Operations and roots

E1. (a) -5. (b) 4. (c) 6. (d) 27. (e) 49. (f) 12.

E2. (a) $\sqrt{16} = 4$, rational. (b) $\sqrt{7}$, irrational. (c) $\sqrt{100} = 10$, rational. (d) $\sqrt{50}$, irrational because the nonnegative integer 50 is not a perfect square. It also equals $5\sqrt{2}$.

E3. The first left side is $6(2) = 12$; the right side is $\sqrt{144} = 12$. In the second check, $\sqrt{9}\sqrt{9} = 3(3) = 9$ and $\sqrt{9 \cdot 9} = \sqrt{81} = 9$. Products of principal square roots obey this rule for nonnegative real quantities under the roots.

Practice F: Recursion

F1. (a) $5, 9, 13, 17, 21, 25$, additive.

(b) $1, 3, 9, 27, 81, 243$, multiplicative.

(c) $100, 90, 80, 70, 60, 50$, additive with change -10.

(d) $2, 1, 1/2, 1/4, 1/8, 1/16$, multiplicative with factor $1/2$.

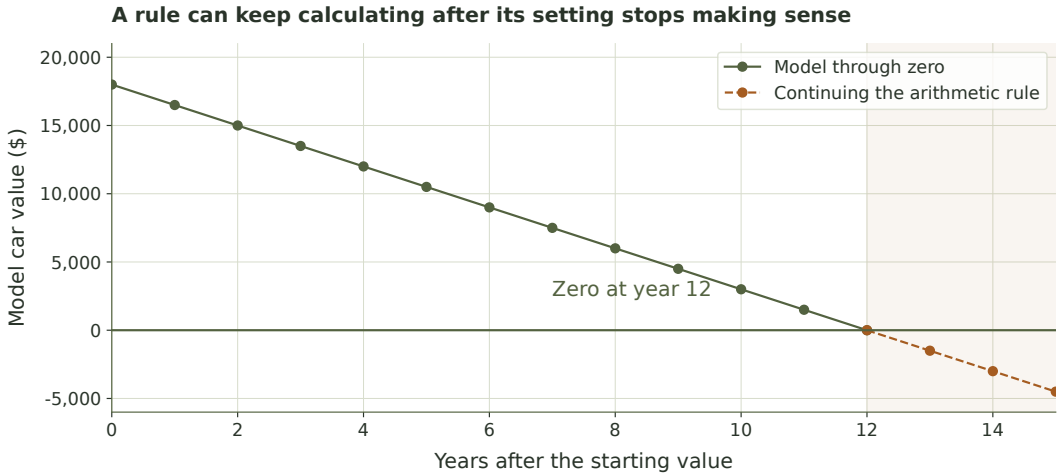
Six terms include the start and five updates.

F2. $b_0 = 500$ and $b_{n+1} = 2b_n$. The direct formula is $b_n = 500(2^n)$.

Hour n	Model population
0	500
1	1000
2	2000
3	4000
4	8000
5	16000

The doubled counts follow the mathematical rule; an actual culture can encounter limits.

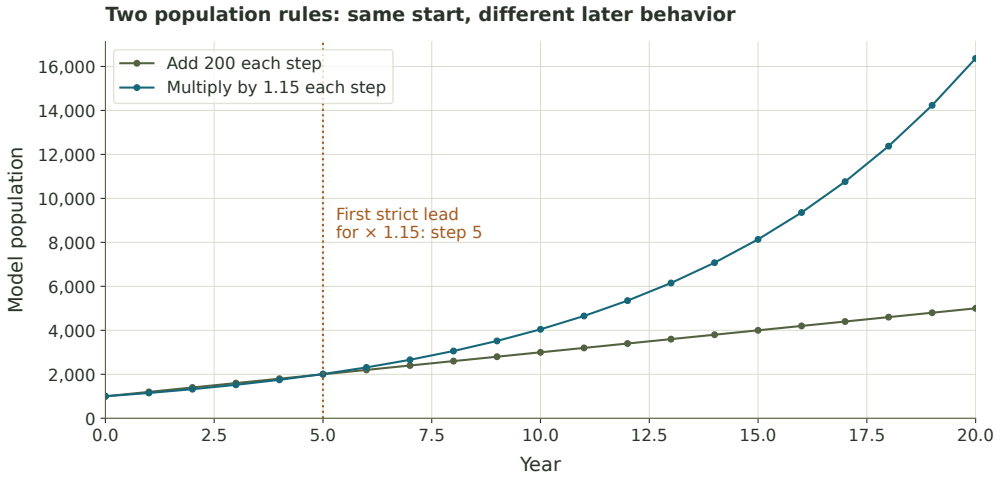
F3. The first six values are $18{,}000, 16{,}500, 15{,}000, 13{,}500, 12{,}000, 10{,}500$ dollars. Solve $18{,}000 - 1{,}500n = 0$ to obtain $n = 12$ years.



The arithmetic becomes negative after year 12. That extension shows where the rule needs reconsideration as a model of car value.

F4. Predict B. By year 5, B is about 2,011.36 while A is 2,000, and B is already gaining more than 200 per year; its annual gain continues to increase under the fixed 15% rule, so it remains ahead through year 20 if the rules continue.

Year	A: add 200	B: multiply by 1.15
0	1000	1,000.00
1	1200	1,150.00
2	1400	1,322.50
3	1600	1,520.88
4	1800	1,749.01
5	2000	2,011.36

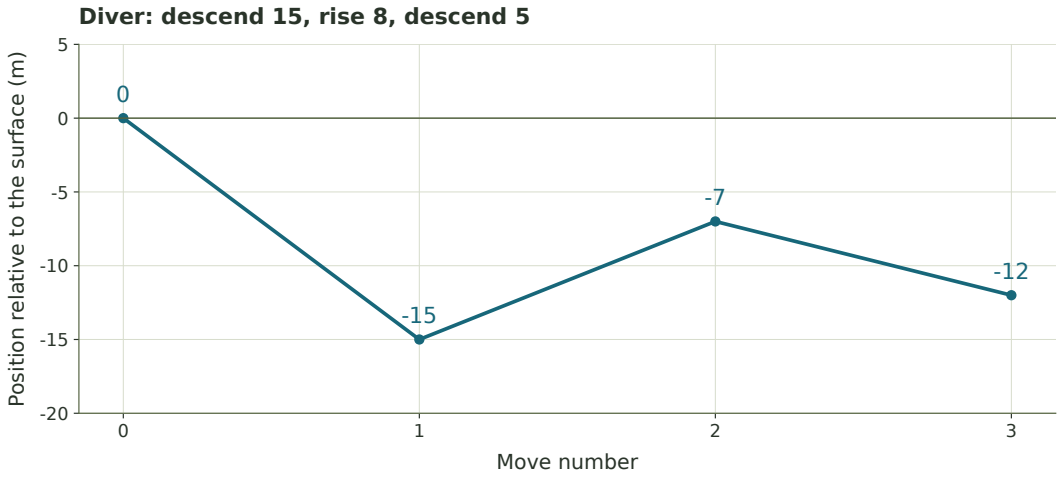


A numerical check at year 20 gives A = 5,000 and B approximately 16,366.54. The prediction above uses only the behavior through year 5.

Chapter 1 review

R1. (a) $8/4 = 2$: N. (b) -17: Z. (c) $\sqrt{11}$: R, real but irrational. (d) $-6/2 = -3$: Z.

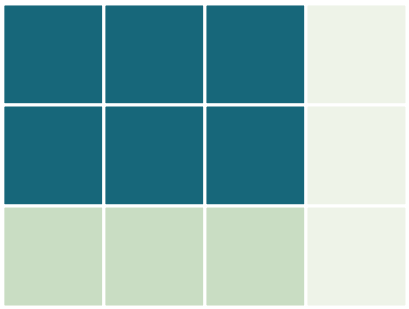
R2. $0 + (-15) = -15$, then $-15 + 8 = -7$, then $-7 + (-5) = -12$. The final position is -12 meters relative to the surface: the diver is 12 meters below it.



Signed position and depth below the surface use different descriptions of the same stop.

R3. Both simplify to $4/7$: divide $8/14$ by 2 and $12/21$ by 3. The original cross-products agree: $8(21) = 14(12) = 168$.

R4. $(2/3)(3/4) = 6/12 = 1/2$ cup.



Original amount: 3/4 = 9/12 cup

Take 2 of its 3 rows:

(2/3) × (3/4) = 6/12 = 1/2 cup

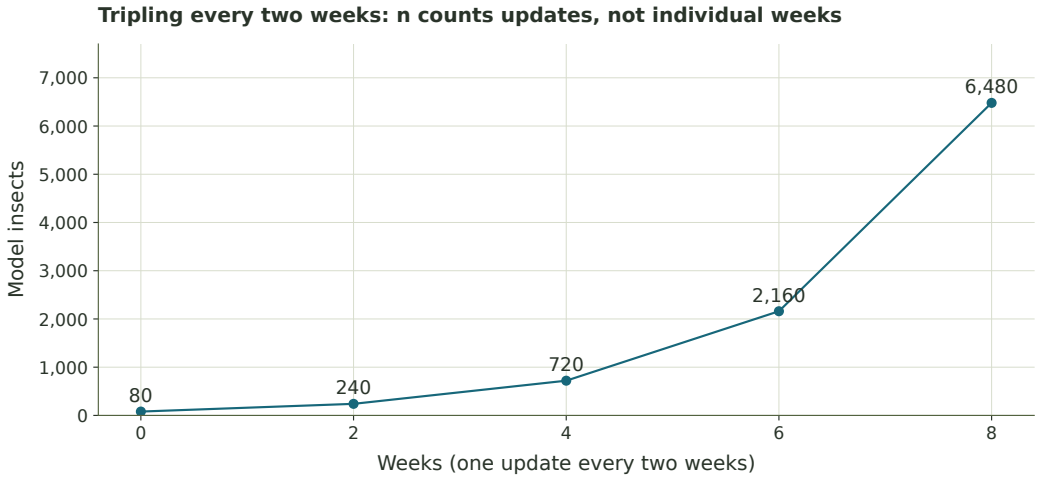
The full 4-by-3 rectangle represents one cup.

Two thirds of the original three-quarter cup is half a cup.

R5.

Weeks	Two-week updates n	Model insects
0	0	80
2	1	240
4	2	720
6	3	2160
8	4	6480

The direct formula is $P_n = 80(3^n)$, with one update every two weeks. This is multiplicative recursion; n is not the number of individual weeks.



The update interval must match the exponent in the model.

R6. This is additive with change 0.5: $a_n = 5 + 0.5n$. At step 20, $a_{20} = 5 + 0.5(20) = 15$.

R7. First take the square root and square: $8+9-((-4)\cdot 2)$. Multiply inside the parentheses to get $8 + 9 - (-8)$, then add the opposite: $8 + 9 + 8 = 25$.

R8. The unit-square diagonal has a real length whose square is 2. If that length were a reduced fraction p/q, then $p^2 = 2q^2$ would force both p and q to be even, contradicting lowest terms, so the length is irrational.